

Post-incident review PIR-2025-039

Notification Service: partial outage

Contoso Platform Engineering. Fictional sample data.

Summary

On 27 March 2025, Notification Service experienced partial outage in production (AU East) for about 25 minutes. The first signal was a spike in support tickets from merchants. Investigation found that one tenant's bulk import consumed most of the shared queue throughput.

Impact

Users of Notification Service saw partial outage for about 25 minutes. The service owner, Messaging, led the response.

Timeline

- 09:13 First signal received.
- 09:32 Incident declared and on-call team engaged.
- 09:51 Likely cause identified.
- 10:15 Mitigation applied.
- 10:54 Service confirmed healthy and incident closed.

What happened

Investigation found that one tenant's bulk import consumed most of the shared queue throughput.

It took time to work out which team owned the affected component.

What went well

Responders communicated clearly in the incident channel and the status page was updated within fifteen minutes of the incident being declared.

Actions

- Review alert thresholds so the alert only fires when action is needed.
- Write and rehearse a runbook for this failure mode.
- Assign a named owner for the component in the service catalogue.